1. Purpose

To establish a standardized process for the prevention, control, and absolute segregation of biological, chemical, and physical hazards, as well as major food allergens, across the Warehouse, Commissary, and Store levels to ensure absolute food safety, protect consumer health, and maintain strict corporate and legal compliance throughout storage, preparation, and service.

2. Scope

Defines the mandatory requirements and operational protocols for preventing biological, chemical, and physical cross-contamination , as well as allergen cross-contact , across all company infrastructure and processes. This policy applies strictly to all employees and operations within the Warehouse, Commissary, and Stores. It encompasses raw material intake security , vertical and spatial storage segregation , hardware color-coding systems , personnel and visitor hygiene controls and culinary thermal flow boundaries. The objective is to guarantee absolute food safety , maintain legal and regulatory compliance , and protect the health and well-being of all guests and employees.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. Warehouse Manager

Shall ensure food safety by establishing and enforcing a strict storage hierarchy, including storing raw proteins below ready-to-eat items and clearly segregating major allergens; oversee the chemical storage area to guarantee total isolation from food products; and maintain comprehensive pest control and waste management programs to actively prevent biological contamination throughout the facility.

3.2. Receiving Employee

Shall serve as the first line of defense by thoroughly inspecting incoming delivery trucks for cleanliness, pest activity, and proper temperature control. They are responsible for rejecting any damaged, leaking, or compromised packaging that could spill and cross-contaminate other goods. Upon arrival, they ensure that raw meats and allergens are transferred immediately to their designated, segregated storage zones to maintain product integrity.

3.3. Warehousing Employees

Shall be responsible for the daily execution of inventory rotation by following the "First In, First Out" (FIFO) and “First Expired, First Out” (FEFO) method while maintaining strict physical separation between different food categories. They are trained to immediately clean and sanitize any spills—especially allergens or raw liquids—using designated, color-coded warehouse cleanup tools to prevent cross-contact.

3.4. Commissary Supervisor

Shall oversee the absolute enforcement of storage zone control, material contamination prevention, and hardware color-coding protocols within the commissary production environment. The supervisor is also responsible for structuring and directing daily preparation schedules according to the chronological batching sequence—ensuring allergen-free and ready-to-eat (RTE) items are processed during a "clean run" at shift start, while items containing major allergens or raw meat marinations are intentionally scheduled at the end of the production cycle. The supervisor shall guarantee that all batch ingredients and work-in-process items remain securely covered in food-grade containers, mandate strict compliance with thawing integrity protocols on the lowest

racks of chillers, and coordinate immediate spill containment and area sanitization using dedicated cleanup tools in the event of a raw protein or allergen breach.

3.5. Commissary Assistant

Shall assist the Commissary Supervisor in executing daily production runs and maintaining strict segregation of allergens and raw proteins. This role shall use and maintain the designated color-coded equipment, ensuring cutting boards, towels, and utensils are properly separated by food group. Furthermore, they shall execute rigorous personal hygiene protocols, including required handwashing and glove changes, when switching tasks or handling different ingredients.

3.6. Line Leads

Shall ensure real-time operational compliance with the hardware color-coding matrix at their specific station, verifying that cutting boards, knives, and prep utensils are used exclusively for their designated food categories. They are required to change their gloves, every single time they switch tasks or handle a different food type. Finally, line leads shall ensure that all batch ingredients remain securely covered and sealed when not actively processed, strictly maintain the absolute line of demarcation between raw protein and cooked protein retrieval at the cooking line, require station surfaces to be stripped, washed, and sanitized immediately following raw preparation sequences, and execute immediate on-the-spot corrections.

3.7. Restaurant Manager

Shall ensure the entire store has an adequate supply of color-coded tools, towels, and functioning handwashing sinks. This role implements a strict policy regarding sick employees to prevent the spread of foodborne viruses (e.g. Norovirus) to food and surfaces. Additionally, the restaurant manager acts as the final authority on food safety compliance during all health inspections.

3.8. Shift Manager

Shall conduct regular line checks to ensure cold and hot holding temperatures are correct, successfully inhibiting bacterial growth. This position monitors employee behavior during peak hours to ensure that operational speed does not compromise critical food safety practices, such as proper and timely glove changes.

3.9. Kitchen Captain

Shall direct the line flow to ensure raw proteins never come into contact with fresh produce or Ready to Eat (RTE) items. This role closely oversees the cooling and reheating processes, ensuring food passes through the "temperature danger zone" as quickly as possible by utilizing clean, shallow containers.

3.10. Back of House (BOH) Employee

Shall adhere strictly to chest freezers and vertical refrigerators storage rules, keeping raw poultry at the bottom and ready-to-eat items at the top. They must clean and sanitize prep stations immediately after working with raw meat, seafood, or eggs. Furthermore, they must never use the same tongs or plates for both raw and cooked meat at the grill station.

3.11. Front of House (FOH) Employee

Shall handle clean glassware, plates, and utensils by the bases and handles only, keeping fingers entirely away from food-contact surfaces. They must alert the kitchen immediately if a guest modifies an order due to a severe food allergy, ensuring a clean protocol is activated to prepare the meal safely. Additionally, they must use designated towels for guest tables, ensuring they never mix with towels used for food prep surfaces.

3.12. Quality Assurance (QA)

Shall conduct routine unannounced inspections across the Warehouse, Commissary, and Store levels to verify policy adherence. This role shall oversee all food safety training programs, ensuring employee certification in allergen management and color-coding systems. In the event of an issue, they shall investigate incidents to implement corrective and preventive actions (CAPA). Furthermore, they shall review critical food safety documentation to ensure compliance.

3.13. Learning & Development (L&D) Manager

Shall oversee the coordination of training modules, focusing specifically on both onboarding and regular refresher courses for store-level operational employees. Partnering closely with Quality Assurance (QA), this role shall track store employees' training completion and proactively verify their individual certifications in critical safety protocols, including the hardware color-coding systems and strict allergen management. To ensure the store maintains complete audit readiness, the L&D Manager shall maintain meticulous documentation of these training records for all store employees, coordinating these records closely with Human Resources (HR).

4. Definition of Terms

- **15-Minute Cold Chain Rule**: The mandatory operational window requiring all accepted temperature-sensitive chilled (≤5°C) or frozen (≤-18°C) products to be transferred from the loading bay into deep cold storage within 15 minutes of vehicle arrival.
- **Chemical Segregation**: The strict spatial requirement mandating that chemicals (e.g., dishwashing liquids, sanitizers, degreasers, pest control sprays) must never be stored in the same room, rack, cabinet, or top shelf as food products, utensils, or single-use packaging.
- **Cross-Contact**: The inadvertent transfer of a major food allergen from one food, tool, or surface to another. Unlike biological hazards, allergens cannot be eliminated or killed by cooking.
- **Cross-Contamination**: The accidental transfer of biological (bacteria like *Salmonella*, *E. coli*, and *Campylobacter*) , chemical, or physical hazards from raw materials, poorly sanitized surfaces, or non-food items to work-in-process or finished food products.
- **First Expired, First Out (FEFO)**: An inventory management methodology where products with the earliest expiration dates are used or distributed first, regardless of their arrival date.
- **First In, First Out (FIFO)**: An inventory rotation method where older stock or previously prepped batches are positioned at the front or top to be exhausted first, ensuring product freshness and preventing expiration.
- **Hygienic Reset**: The mandatory protocol of washing hands using the validated 6-step method for at least 20 seconds and donning a fresh pair of disposable gloves before switching between distinct processing activities or different food groups.
- **Quarantine**: The immediate isolation and physical tagging (using a red "HOLD" sticker) of incoming products that have minor documentary discrepancies but pass physical safety parameters, preventing them from mixing with general inventory.
- **Ready-to-Eat (RTE)**: Food items that are fully processed, cooked, or prepared and require no further thermal treatment before being served to the guest (e.g., cooked broths, dipping sauces, condiments, and cooked side items).
- **Temperature Danger Zone**: The critical thermal range between 4°C to 60°C (40°F and 140°F) where biological pathogens and microbial growth rapidly proliferate.

5. Hardware Color Coding

To ensure food safety and protect consumer health, the commissary and store operates on the principle of absolute segregation. Cross-contamination is prevented by maintaining strict, visible boundaries between distinct food groups, raw and ready-to-eat (RTE) states, and major food allergens throughout storage, preparation, and service.

5.1. Cutting Board Color-Coding

To prevent the transfer of harmful bacteria (such as *Salmonella*, *E. coli*, and *Campylobacter*) between raw and ready-to-eat foods, specific cutting boards must be used exclusively for their designated food groups.

Color	Food Category	Standard Items
🔴 **Red**	Raw Meat	Beef, Pork, Lamb
🟡 **Yellow**	Raw Poultry	Chicken, Turkey, Duck
🔵 **Blue**	Raw Seafood	Fish and shellfish
🟢 **Green**	Produce	Fresh Fruits and Vegetables
🟤 **Brown**	Dairy & Cooked Foods	Dairy products and pre-cooked items
⚪ **White**	Allergen-Free	**Strictly** for allergen-free orders (No exceptions)

5.2. Sanitation & Towel Color-Coding

Using the wrong towel in the wrong area is a primary driver of chemical and biological cross-contamination. Towels must remain in their designated areas and never cross thresholds.

Color	Operational Area	Approved Usage & Critical Rules
🔵 **Blue**	Front of House (FOH)	Dining areas, guest tables, and service counters.
🟡 **Yellow**	Handwashing Stations	Dedicated hand-hygiene areas only.
🟢 **Green**	Back of House (BOH)	General kitchen preparation and cooking lines.

⚪ **White**	Kitchen Wares & Plating	Strictly reserved for drying and wiping clean kitchen wares, plates, and utensils.
🔴 **Red**	Restroom & Sanitation	Comfort rooms, restrooms, and high-risk sanitation areas. **NOTE:** Never bring a red towel into a food prep zone.

5.3. Meat Serving Plates Color-Coding

To eliminate any confusion during plating and service—and to guarantee that raw juices never contact cooked items—serving plates designated for meats are color-coded as follows:

Color	Approved Usage
🔴 **Red**	Intended for US Beef
🟡 **Yellow**	
🟤 **Brown**	
🟢 **Green**	Intended for Pork Belly
🟠 **Orange**	Intended for Angus Beef

6. Intake, Defense, and Thermal Verification

6.1. Receiving and Gateway Security

Every incoming shipment whether arriving at the warehouse, commissary, or store must undergo a mandatory documentary and physical inspection before unloading. The receiving employee acts as the primary line of defense.

a. **Documentary Check:** Verify Certificates of Analysis and "one-step-back" traceability data.
b. **Physical Inspection:** Immediately reject any materials showing evidence of pest infestation, damaged packaging, or broken seals at the bay to prevent biological or physical vectors from entering the facility.

6.2. The 15-Minute Cold Chain Rule

Temperature abuse accelerates biological growth and pathogen crossover.

a. **Measurement:** Internal temperatures of high-risk goods must be recorded upon intake. Chilled goods must be ≤5°C and frozen goods ≤-18°C with zero signs of thawing.
b. **Transfer Window:** All accepted temperature-sensitive products must be moved from the loading area into deep cold storage within **15 minutes** of vehicle arrival to maintain thermal integrity.

6.3. Non-Conforming Quarantine

a. If a delivery presents minor documentary discrepancies but satisfies all physical safety parameters, the items must be completely isolated.

b. They must be physically tagged with a yellow **"HOLD"** sticker and moved immediately to a designated, restricted quarantine area until the supplier resolves the trace data. They must never mix with general inventory.

7. Spatial Segregation and Storage Life

7.1. Vertical Storage Hierarchy

To prevent any possibility of food-to-food cross-contamination, all products stored inside upright refrigeration units must be systematically layered from top to bottom based strictly on their processing status and hazard levels:

a. **Top Shelves (Ready-to-Eat / Prepared Items):** This zone houses cooked broths, dipping sauce blends, condiments, and pre-portioned cooked side items. All items in this tier must be kept in clear, tightly sealed, lidded plastic containers.

b. **Middle Shelves (Fresh Produce & Leafy Greens):** This zone is strictly reserved for washed and portioned vegetables. To guarantee proper air circulation and prevent moisture damage, vegetables must be organized into uniform, perforated plastic baskets.

c. **Lower Shelves / Specific Dedicated Units (Raw Proteins):** Raw sliced meats, hotpot meatballs, and raw seafood must be completely isolated to the lowest shelves or stored in entirely designated units (such as specific "GRILL" freezer units). Raw proteins must never be placed on shelves above cooked items or raw vegetables.

7.2. Under-Counter Backup Chiller Protocols

To prevent cross-contamination and maintain strict organizational control at the hotpot service line, the refrigeration compartments directly below the service counter must be managed under the following rules:

a. **Inventory Isolation:** Under-counter backup chillers must strictly hold exact backup replacements for the service line.

b. **Contamination Barriers:** All items stored within these under-counter compartments must be packed in clear, labeled, lidded bins to protect the ingredients from external exposure.

c. **Operational Flow & Safety:** Keeping exact replacements directly below the line enables immediate replenishment during high-volume service hours. This ensures that employees do not need to leave the line to retrieve stock, minimizing cross-zone movement during peak operational windows.

d. **Mandatory Labeling:** Every backup container must feature a standardized printed white label facing outwards toward the user. Handwritten markings directly on the plastic surfaces are strictly prohibited. The labels must explicitly specify the Item Description, Prep/Opening Date, Expiration Date, and the initials of the responsible employee.

e. **Stock Rotation (FIFO):** Kitchen employees must strictly enforce the First-In, First-Out (FIFO) system within these chillers. Newly prepped backup batches must always be positioned behind or underneath the existing inventory. Employees must pull items exclusively from the front of the rows or the top of the stacks to ensure older stock is exhausted first and to prevent product expiration.

7.3. Chemical Storage Rules

To completely eliminate the risk of accidental chemical contamination in food products, packaging, or utensils, the following vertical and spatial hierarchies must be strictly enforced across all premises:

a. **Chemical Segregation:** Chemicals including dishwashing liquid, degreasers, sanitizers, floor cleaners, and pest control sprays must NEVER be stored in the same room, rack, or cabinet as food items, food contact utensils, or single-use packaging (such as takeaway boxes and cups).
b. **Dedicated Chemical Station:** Every branch must designate a specific, locked cabinet or isolated shelving unit that is clearly marked: "CHEMICAL STORAGE ONLY".
c. **Under-Sink/Floor Level Storage:** If chemicals are kept near a dishwashing or cleaning sink, they must be placed exclusively on the lowest shelf or floor-level drip trays. Chemicals must NEVER be placed on top shelves where they could leak, drip, or spill downward onto clean plates, utensils, or food prep counters

7.4. Zone Control and Material Contamination Prevention

a. **Authorized Storage Items:** Only active inventory, authorized utensils, and sanitized food-grade storage containers are permitted within food preparation and storage zones. Non-essential objects must never clutter storage spaces.
b. **Daily Waste Removal:** Every day, empty cardboard boxes, unauthorized materials, and damaged utensils must be physically removed from the storage and kitchen areas to maintain cleanliness.
c. **Service Line Protection:** Immediate-use items kept in stainless steel gastronorm pans inset into the chilled prep line must be securely covered with pristine plastic wrap or lids during off-peak operational windows to retain freshness and prevent airborne contamination.
d. **Handling of Expired or Damaged Goods:** Daily sorting must be executed by kitchen and warehouse employees so that any expired or damaged goods are promptly logged and removed from the storage facility. These items must be immediately recorded in the Disposal Log and discarded entirely from the facility to prevent accidental use.

8. Service, Environment, and Allergen Controls

8.1. Allergen Management & Absolute Importance

Cross-contact occurs when an allergen is inadvertently transferred from one food or surface to another. While cooking kills bacteria, it does not eliminate food allergens. For a guest with a severe allergy, cross-contact can cause a life-threatening anaphylactic reaction.

a. **Allergen Protocol:** To ensure absolute safety when handling an allergen-free order, you must first wash your hands and change your gloves completely before beginning preparation. The white cutting board is strictly reserved for these orders and must remain entirely uncontaminated, meaning it must be washed, rinsed, and sanitized immediately before use. This level of care extends to all equipment; you must use completely fresh, sanitized knives, tongs, and pans when executing the order. Finally, a strict policy of zero substitution applies: if a mistake is made and an allergen touches a plate, you cannot simply "wipe away" or remove the ingredient. Instead, the entire meal must be discarded and restarted from scratch.

8.2. Personnel Health, Attire, and Visual Screening

a. **Hygienic Uniform:** All employees must arrive in a clean, corporate uniform. Hair restraints (nets/caps) must completely enclose all hair; facial hair must be cleanly shaved or covered with a beard snood. Aprons must be removed before entering the restroom, and closed-toe safety footwear is mandatory.

b. **Pre-Shift Visual Health Check:** Managers must perform a proactive daily health check (visual screening for jaundice, open skin infections, or acute respiratory distress, accompanied by a direct verbal inquiry) before any employee steps onto the floor.

c. **Exclusion Policy:** Any employee exhibiting symptoms of foodborne illness (vomiting, diarrhea, fever) must be immediately excluded from the premises and cannot return until they have been completely asymptomatic for 24 to 48 hours, or provide formal written medical clearance.

8.3. Visitor and Contractor Contamination Control

To eliminate biological, physical, and chemical cross-contamination hazards introduced by non-employees (visitors, contractors, suppliers, and guests), the following entry and operational standards must be strictly enforced:

a. **Pre-Entry Screening & Traceability:** Entry is prohibited for any individual with a communicable disease, open wound, or infection, and visitors are legally obligated to disclose these conditions. Before entering, security or designated employees must perform health checks, record body temperature screenings, and ensure the individual signs and updates the Visitor's Logbook at both arrival and departure to maintain a verifiable audit trail.

b. **Grooming, Attire, and Physical Controls:** Visitors entering processing areas must keep fingernails short and refrain from wearing cosmetics, perfumes, hairspray, or jewelry. All shirt pockets must be emptied, and managers will perform a strict inventory count of all personal effects (such as pens and glasses). Additionally, employees will inspect and record a precise count of clothing buttons before entry and verify the count again upon departure to prevent foreign material contamination.

c. **Mandatory Protective Equipment:** Before entering production zones, individuals must change into assigned uniforms or gowns using designated lockers under Quality Assurance (QA) oversight. Mandatory sanitary gear provided at the security post or main office must be worn, including head caps, hairnets, beard/mustache covers, socks, and company-provided footwear. Lab gowns must be thoroughly lint-rolled prior to entry to strip away loose fibers and hair.

d. **Hygiene & Zone Behavior Standards:** Hands must be thoroughly washed and sanitized prior to entry, after using restrooms, or whenever physically soiled. Within processing zones, eating, drinking, candy, gum, smoking, glass, and outside food items are strictly banned (consumption is limited to the canteen or external areas). Spitting, urinating outside of restrooms, and littering are strictly prohibited; all waste must go into covered bins. Finally, electronic gadgets, including mobile phones and cameras, are banned within the production plant to protect intellectual property and eliminate high-touch vectors.

9. Processing, Preparation, and Hygiene Controls

9.1. Chronological Batching Sequence

Daily preparation and production schedules must be structured chronologically based on biological and allergen risk profiles:

a. **Shift Start (Clean Run):** Process and portion allergen-free items, ready-to-eat (RTE) proprietary items, and clean vegetables.

b. **Shift End (Allergen/Raw Run):** Intentionally schedule items containing major allergens or raw meat marination at the end of the production cycle to systematically prevent allergen carryover or biological contamination of clean batches.

c. **Batch Integrity:** All raw materials and work-in-process items must remain securely covered in food-grade containers when not actively being processed on the line.

9.2. Task-Transition Hygiene & Station Practices

a. **The Hygienic Reset:** Employees must perform a complete hygienic reset between distinct processing activities. Switching from handling a raw protein to a cooked component, or shifting from an allergen-heavy batch to an allergen-free run, mandates executing the validated **6-step handwashing method for at least 20 seconds** and donning a fresh pair of disposable gloves.

b. **Hardware Matrix Enforcement:** Employees must exclusively utilize station-assigned, color-coded cutting boards, knives, and prep utensils. Mixing tools across color categories is a critical non-compliance violation.

9.3. Thawing Integrity Protocols

a. Raw proteins must be thawed strictly under the four approved corporate methods (such as controlled chiller thawing at ≤5°C).

b. Thawing items must sit exclusively on the lowest racks of the thawing chillers to ensure condensation or raw juices do not drip onto surrounding surfaces. Thawing at room temperature on an open counter or loading dock is strictly prohibited.

c. Surface-reconditioning or surface-searing techniques are completely forbidden on ground meats or comminuted products due to pathogen migration risks.

9.4. Culinary Thermal Flow and Line Boundaries

a. **The Temperature Danger Zone:** To prevent rapid microbial proliferation, cooked food undergoing cooling or reheating must traverse the danger zone (40°F - 140°F / 4°C - 60°C) as rapidly as possible using clean ice baths and shallow stainless-steel containers.

b. **Thermal Failure Rule:** If a localized power failure or cooling unit breach lasts for more than 3 hours in a hot kitchen (>30°C), products must be verified and immediately discarded due to the risk of heat-stable, pre-formed bacterial toxins.

c. **The Cooking Line Boundary:** The line of demarcation between raw and cooked food at the cooking lines is absolute. Line cooks must use entirely separate, dedicated tongs and plates for raw protein placement versus cooked protein retrieval. Station surfaces must be stripped, washed, and sanitized immediately after any raw preparation sequence.

9.5. Spill Response and Sourcing Integrity

a. **Spill Containment:** Any spill involving a raw protein juice or a major allergen must be treated as an immediate contamination hazard. Employees must instantly cordon off the zone, use dedicated color-coded cleanup tools/spill kits, and thoroughly wash, rinse, and sanitize the area before normal traffic resumes.

b. **Food Fraud Mitigation :** There must be zero unauthorized substitution of high-risk ingredients (e.g., swapping premium Angus beef for a lesser grade, or substituting oils). All prepared proteins must perfectly match corporate-approved menu definitions and sourcing standards to prevent undisclosed allergen introduction.

10. Corrective Action

Failure to comply with the protocols undermines the safety of our guests and the company's legal compliance.

- **Minor Violations:** First-time behavioral infractions (e.g., accidental tool mix-ups immediately corrected) will result in immediate on-the-spot correction by Restaurant and Shift Managers.
- **Major or Repeated Violations:** Intentional non-compliance, falsification of logs, or repeated failures to execute critical safety measures (e.g., ignoring raw protein storage hierarchies or mixing restroom towels into food prep zones) will result in formal disciplinary action and mandatory retraining partnership with L&D.

11. Verification

The Quality Assurance (QA) team ensures strict adherence to policy by conducting routine, unannounced inspections across the Warehouse, Commissary, and Store levels. In addition to these physical inspections, the QA team performs a thorough evaluation of all food safety logs and associated documentation to guarantee ongoing regulatory compliance. Furthermore, the Learning & Development (L&D) Manager oversees the organization-wide coordination of training modules, including both onboarding and regular refresher courses for all operational levels. To maintain audit readiness, the L&D manager, in partnership with QA, tracks employee training completion, verifies individual certifications in color-coding systems and allergen management, and maintains meticulous documentation of these records for all employees.

12. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	June 18, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez, **QA Specialist**	Originator

	Name	Position	Signature with Date
Prepared by	Celine Joy Sanchez	QA Specialist	
Reviewed by	Jackquelyn Aquino	SCM Manager	
	Virna Joy Bernardo	L&D Manager	
	Anthony Co	HR Manager	
	Aries Tambasacan	Operations Manager	
	Eric Co	Vice President	
Approved by	Jack Julius Tiu	President	